

"Since cell changes associated with the development of cancer lead to colour changes in tissues, we believe that hyperspectral imaging could help us to improve the specificity of lesion identification because we can use these colours to identify abnormal tissues," adds Dr Bohndiek.

Bendable battery to power future wearable devices, smartphones

Panasonic is developing a new bendable lithium-ion battery that can flex and twist to power wearable devices and one day be used to develop a flexible smartphone. Although it is still in the early stages of development, the battery has already been tested to withstand twists, bends and other deformations while maintaining its ability to hold a charge.



The bendable battery is just 0.55mm (0.02-inch) thick, and was able to withstand being bent so that the curve of the battery has a radius of 25mm, and being twisted up to 25 degrees in tests (Image courtesy: www.yahoo.com/tech/)

In contrast, a regular lithium-ion battery, commonly used in smartphones and other gadgets, can degrade when it is deformed, thus shortening the device's operating time.

Panasonic's bendable battery uses a newly-developed laminated outer body and internal structure that the company

says makes it difficult for the battery to leak or over-heat. With this new casing and internal wiring, the battery is safer and more reliable for wearable tech devices.

AI robot teaches humans ping pong

The name FORPHEUS comes from Future Omron Robotics technology for Exploring Possibility of Harmonized Automation with Sinic theoretics. A coined term embodying OMRON's robot technologies based on its unique future prediction theory—SINIC theoretics. It is also a combina-



FORPHEUS was recently named the world's first robot table tennis tutor by Guinness World Records. It's now being updated in order to return balls with greater accuracy using artificial intelligence (Image courtesy: <https://uk.news.yahoo.com/>)

tion of For and ORPHEUS (a bard in Greek mythology as a symbol of human creativity), representing OMRON's attitude of bringing out human creativity and possibility.

Robot FORPHEUS aims to improve your table tennis skills while having fun at the same time by keeping a rally going. In addition to the conventional function to control returning the ball according to the trajectory and strength of the ball, the third-generation FORPHEUS is equipped with new amazing technologies where you and machines grow together by using artificial intelligence (AI) technologies.

FORPHEUS can learn about characteristics of your actions and the trajectory of the ball and keep a rally going, which guides you to make more progress. Further, the degree of harmony between you and the machine has been made visible through the rally.

Levitating turntable that can play records in the air

A Kickstarter campaign has been launched to bring the first levitating turntable into production, the Vinyl Factory notes. Mag-Lev Audio, a Slovenian company, is hoping to raise US\$ 300,000 to manufacture the machines, which are designed for people who appreciate high quality sound and innovative design.

The turntables will use a magnetic platter to suspend the vinyl record during playback. By pushing the frontier



The turntable includes a cueing mechanism, speed select button, platter feet and a pre-fitted cartridge and tonearm that lifts at the end of the record (Image courtesy: www.kickstarter.com/)

of audio technology, the makers were able to integrate the uplifting experience of music into the turntable design itself, bringing the feeling of zero gravity into the living room.

As for making that vinyl float, the Kickstarter page says, "By using our innovative and patented technology, we were able to achieve not only magnetic levitation, but we have also been able to maintain the incredibly precise turning of the platter with sensor regulating software. Air is the smoothest medium with the least amount of friction, which further elevates this project into a truly unique listening experience." The design also includes feet to support the platter in off mode, and a safety system in case of unexpected power outage.